2.3 Improving your web search

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to improve a basic web search.

In the last lesson you learned how to use key words to carry out a basic search. In this lesson you will learn how to make your searches more useful.

Removing items from a search

In the last lesson you helped Selina search for vegetarian pizza recipes. You may have used a search question like this one:

pizza recipe vegetarian

The sites you found will have included recipes for margherita pizza. Selina already knows about that type of pizza, so it isn't what she is looking for. You can remove 'margherita' from the search using a minus symbol (–). The new search looks like this:

pizza recipe vegetarian -margherita



Activity

Enter the search string 'pizza recipe vegetarian' and look at the first page of results. Now enter 'pizza recipe vegetarian -margherita'. Are there any changes in the search results?



Be creative

Use your web search skills to create an advert for your favourite pizza. Write a short paragraph that tells people how good your pizza is!



Searching for books and music

You can use other symbols to improve your search. Two symbols that are often used are quote marks (") and an asterisk (*).

If you use double quote marks, the search engine looks for the exact text you have typed. Quote marks are very helpful if you are searching for a book or song title, for example '"The Tiger Who Came to Tea"'.

Use an asterisk if you aren't sure about a word in a song or book title. For example, if you are not sure of the third word in the book, *Where the Wild Things Are*, you could type '"Where the * Things Are"' in your search.



Activity

Search for a review of your favourite book. Use quote marks around the book title.

Use an asterisk to search for a book where you are unsure of the full title.

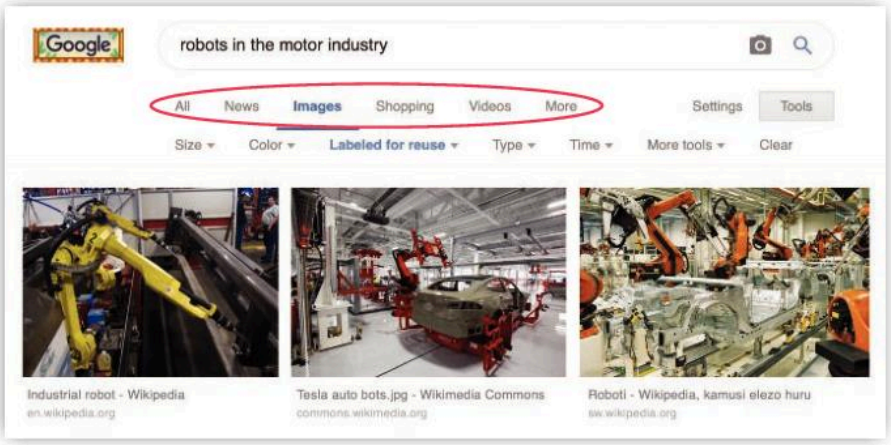


Extra challenge

Use your new skills to help with a piece of homework in another subject.

Searching for pictures and videos

When you have entered a search, a list of links is sent to your browser by the search engine. To see pictures and videos that match your search, click the 'Images' and 'Videos' links underneath the search box.





Explore more

Do other members of your family use the internet? You have learned some useful search skills in this unit. Share them with your family to help them when they use the internet.

2.4 Browsing and using bookmarks

In this lesson

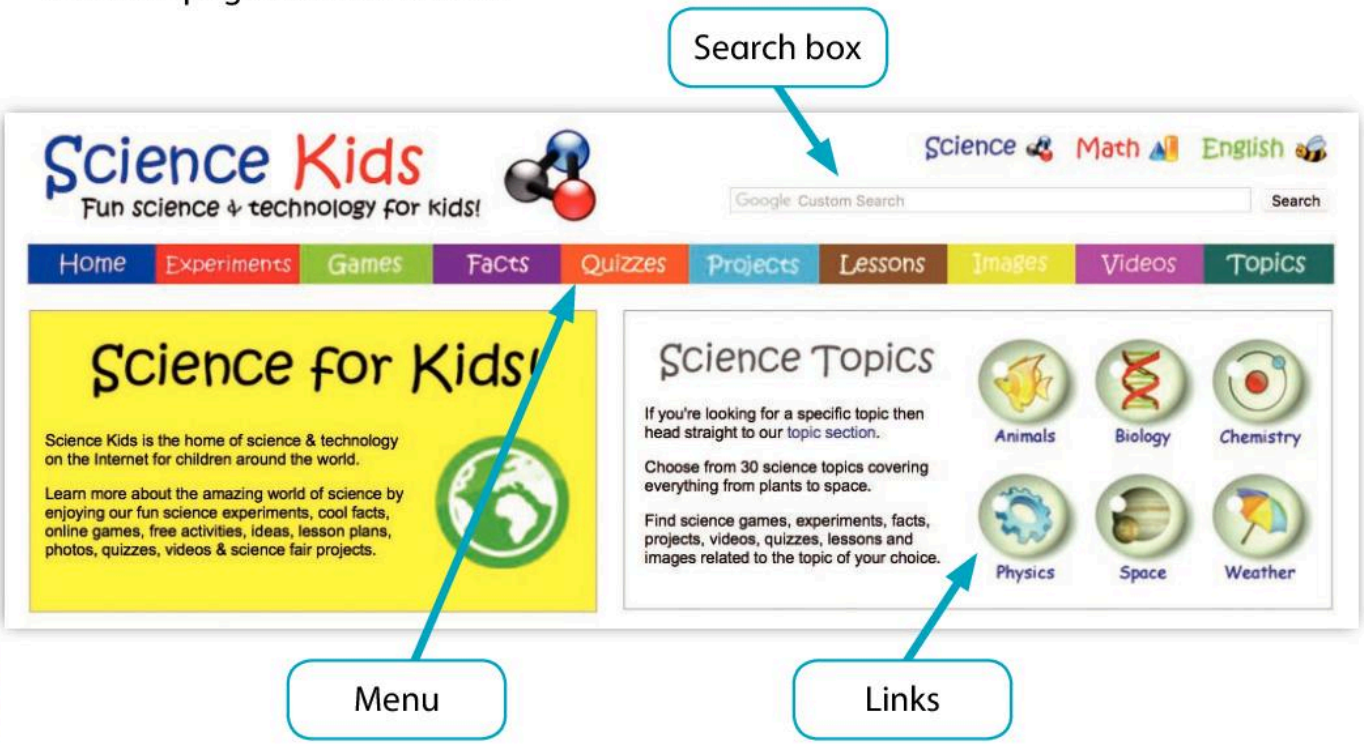
You will learn:

- how to find your way around a website
- how to use bookmarks, so that you can find a website or web page easily.

Finding your way around a website

When you have found a website you are interested in, you can start to browse. You browse a website by moving around the web pages on the site. You don't have to move through a website page by page as you would in a book. A website provides links that take you to the information you are looking for.

- The **menu** tells you how the website is divided into sections. A menu is like the contents page in a book. Clicking on a menu tab takes you to a different section of the website.
- **Links** usually take you to another page on the website. Links can be words or pictures.
- **Search** is like the search engine you have been using, but only searches pages on the website.



Be creative

Write a review of your favourite website. What is the site called? What is it about? What do you like about the site? Is there anything you would improve about the site? Share your review with your friends.

Bookmarks

Bookmarks save useful websites and web pages, so that you can find them again easily. Bookmarks help you get back to a website quickly.

In Lesson 1.5, you learned about saving files in folders. Folders help you to find information you have saved.



You can save your bookmarks into folders. For example, you could have one bookmark folder for each subject you study.

Activity

Work in a small team. Use your web search skills to find websites that have fact files about endangered animals. Use the menu, links and search buttons to find information on different endangered animals.

Choose one endangered animal. Create a poster about it to make people aware that the animal is in danger.

Think again

Create a bookmark folder called Computing. Save the useful sites you find in the folder as you study this course.

As you develop your web search skills, use the internet to research other subjects.

Extra challenge

Create a bookmark for the sites you used in the activity.